

Roberto Ragno

MSCA POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW IN ARCHAEOLOGY

McDonald Institute for Archaeological Research · University of Cambridge

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Education

University of Bari 'Aldo Moro'

PHD QUANTITATIVE ARCHAEOLOGY

Bari, Italy

2020 - 2024

- Graduated with *excellente cum laude*.
- Funded PhD Project: 'Peasants, Agriculture, and Environment in the 1st Millennium CE Italian Countryside: A Bayesian approach'.
- Supervisors: Professor Giuliano Volpe, Professor Paul Arthur.

University College London

MA ARCHAEOLOGY

London, UK

2018 - 2019

- Graduated with distinction.
- Supervisors: Professor Corisande Fenwick, Professor Louise Martin.

University of Bologna

BA ANCIENT HISTORY

Bologna, Italy

2014 - 2018

- Graduated with 107 out of 110.
- Supervisor: Professor Alessandro Cristofori.

Employment

ACADEMIC

University of Cambridge

MARIE SKŁODOWSKA-CURIE ACTIONS POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW

Cambridge, UK

Jan. 2026–Current

- Project: **BTChron**: *Advancing Bayesian Methods for Typo-Chronologically Dated Archaeological Datasets*.
- For this MSCA project, I am developing Bayesian models that incorporate typo-chronological uncertainty in long-term analyses of archaeological change.

St John's College, University of Cambridge

COLLEGE RESEARCH ASSOCIATE

Cambridge, UK

Sep. 2026–Current

- Non-stipendiary college research associateship held concurrently with my MSCA Postdoctoral Fellowship at the McDonald Institute for Archaeological Research.

University of Bari 'Aldo Moro'

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCH FELLOW

Bari, Italy

2024–2025

- Postdoctoral researcher on the project *Historical Landscapes, Population Dynamics and Agrarian Strategies in Northern Coastal Apulia between the Roman Age and the Middle Ages*, funded by the CHANGES PNRR partnership.
- Co-coordinated the *Northern Apulia Coastal Survey*, contributing to survey design, fieldwork, data management, and analysis.
- Mentored undergraduate and Master's students through field training, analytical methods, and dissertation research projects.
- Delivered seminars on archaeological sampling, statistical methods, and landscape archaeology.

INDUSTRY

CoNISMa

CONTRACT ARCHAEOLOGIST

Bari, Italy

Apr. - Jun. 2024

- Archaeological risk assessment for Hope Group floating wind farm project (*Nemetum Island*) in the Gulf of Manfredonia, Italy.

Publications

in press Ragno, R. 2026. Understanding Variation in Zooarchaeological NISP Data: Bayesian Beta-Binomial Models for Italian contexts in the 1st millennium CE. In: Fernandes, R., Harris, A., Hixon, S. and Coccozza, C. (eds.) *Big Historical Data: Theories, Methods, and Applications*. Springer, Berlin. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-38152-1>

in press Carletti, E., Ragno, R. 2026. Cambiamenti climatici nel Mezzogiorno adriatico tra I e II millennio d.C.: fonti scritte e modelli paleoclimatici. In: Goffredo, R., Fiorentino, G., Favia, P. and Turchiano M. (eds.) *ArcheoClima. Cambiamenti climatici e sistemi socio-ecologici della Puglia settentrionale nella lunga durata*. Edipuglia, Bari.

in press Goffredo, R., Lucci, E., Piepoli, L., Ragno, R. 2026. Northern Apulia Coastal Landscape Project. Sistemi ambientali e popolamento costiero tra Neolitico e Medioevo: la piana di Manfredonia. In: Goffredo, R., Fiorentino, G., Favia, P. and Turchiano M. (eds.) *ArcheoClima. Cambiamenti climatici e sistemi socio-ecologici della Puglia settentrionale nella lunga durata*. Edipuglia, Bari.

pre-print Cardarelli, L., **Ragno, R.** (Whose defaults?) Is artificial intelligence reorienting archaeological methods? <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2609.11198>

2026 **Ragno, R.**, Goffredo, R. 2026. Integrating historical sources with climate simulations: temperature and precipitation anomalies in southern Italy (1000-1800 CE). *Quaternary Science Reviews*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110225>

2025 **Ragno, R.**, Goffredo, R., Piepoli, L., 2025. Classifying Functional Areas at the Roman Villa of Mascherone (Manfredonia, Italy): Modeling Sparse Surface Survey Count Data using a Bayesian Zero-Inflated Negative Binomial Model. *Journal of Field Archaeology* 1–15. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00934690.2025.2578563>

2025 Goffredo, R., Lucci, E., Piepoli, L., **Ragno, R.**, 2025. Northern Apulia Coastal Survey: la piana di Siponto tra Neolitico e Medioevo. *FOLD&R Survey* (23), pp. 1–39. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17469416>

2025 **Ragno, R.**, 2025. The transition from Late Antiquity to the Early Middle Ages in Northern Italy: an Environmental Archaeology Approach, in: Abatino, C. et al. (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 10th National Archaeozoological Conference* (Siena, 3rd-6th of November 2021). *ArchaeoFauna*, Madrid, pp. 47–55. <http://www.doi.org/10.15366/archaeofauna2025.34.1.004>

2025 **Ragno, R.** 2025. Peasants, Agriculture, and Environment in the 1st Millennium CE Italian Countryside: A Bayesian approach, *Adrias*, 19. Edipuglia, Bari. ISBN: 979-12-5995-113-7

2025 **Ragno, R.**, 2025. Archaeobotanical Data from the Italian Peninsula in the 1st Millennium CE. *Journal of Open Archaeology Data* 13, 1-6. <https://doi.org/10.5334/joad.147>

2024 **Ragno, R.**, 2024. Sheep and goats taxonomic abundance trends in 1st millennium CE southern Italy: Multilevel bayesian modelling of NISP datasets. *Journal of Archaeological Science* 171, 106068. [10.1016/j.jas.2024.106068](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jas.2024.106068)

2023 **Ragno, R.**, 2023. Cereal farming practices in Italy during the 1st millennium CE: An integrated approach to regionality. *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*, 52, 104287. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jasrep.2023.104287>

2023 **Ragno, R.**, 2023. The Spoil Project. Assessing the Rate of Excavators' Accidental Ceramic Discard at the Archaeological Site of Siponto. *Archeologia e Calcolatori*, 34.2, 69-86. <https://doi.org/10.19282/ac.34.2.2023.04>

2023 **Ragno, R.**, 2023. Towards a Philosophy of Archaeology. *Quaestio*, 23, 472–474. <http://doi.org/10.1484/J.QUAESTIO.5.134735>

Honours & Awards

2025	Awarded , Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Postdoctoral Fellowship, total funding €260,347.92	<i>European Commission</i>
2025	Culture della materia , In: Landscape Archaeology	<i>University of Foggia</i>
2025	Winner , Edipuglia <i>Renzo Ceglie</i> Early Career Researcher Prize	<i>Italy</i>
2022	Culture della materia , In: Methodology of the Archaeological Research	<i>University of Bari</i>
2022	Culture della materia , In: Public Archaeology	<i>University of Bari</i>
2020	PhD scholarship , gross 16,243€/year (duration: 42 months)	<i>University of Bari</i>
2019	Winner , Bryan Clauson Prize for Roman Archaeology (80£)	<i>London, UK</i>
2016	Winner , Ecomap Scholarship (500€)	<i>Italy</i>
2012	Winner , Certamen ‘Giustino Fortunato’ (400€)	<i>Rionero in V., Italy</i>

Conferences

INVITED TALKS

2026 Invited Speaker. *Dialoghi sul patrimonio culturale*, University of Bari, Italy (21–24 Jan). Fiorentino, G., Grasso, A.M., Goffredo, R., Turchiano, M., Favia, P., Carletti, E., **Ragno, R.**, Delprato, U., Garro, L., Marchese, S.A. ArcheoClima. Cambiamenti climatici e sistemi socio-ecologici della Puglia settentrionale nella lunga durata.

2025 Invited Speaker. *Approaches to the Roman Environment* – Workshop, American Academy in Rome, Italy (4 Mar). **Ragno, R.** Tackling uncertainty in Italian agricultural practices during the 1st millennium CE.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Speaker. EAA 2026 – 32nd European Association of Archaeologists Annual Meeting, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece (26–29 Aug). **Ragno, R.** Modelling the Landscape of Roman Viticulture in Continental Italy: An Integrated Approach.

2026 Speaker. CAA 2026 – 53rd Computational Archaeology Association International Conference, University of Vienna, Austria (31 Mar–4 Apr). **Ragno, R.**, Castiello, M.E. Mapping the Potential Location of Roman Winemaking Using Niche Modelling Approaches: A Case Study from Continental Italy.

- 2026** Speaker. *Mappe e scenari per il futuro del patrimonio culturale. Tre anni di ricerche del Partenariato PNRR CHANGES*, Sapienza University of Rome, Italy (14–16 Jan). Goffredo, R., Lucci, E., Piepoli, L., **Ragno, R.** Northern Apulia Coastal Landscapes Project: paesaggi storici della piana di Siponto (Manfredonia).
- 2025** Speaker. CAA 2025 – 52nd Computational Archaeology Association International Conference, University of West Attica, Greece (5–9 May). **Ragno, R.**, Goffredo, R., Piepoli, L. Visibility and Spatial Autocorrelation in Field Survey: A Case Study from the Northern Apulia Coastal Survey using Bayesian Conditional Autoregressive (CAR) Models.
- 2025** Poster. *Patrimonio culturale al futuro: sostenibilità sociale, innovazione tecnologica, trasformazione digitale. Le ricerche in corso nel Progetto CHANGES*, University of Roma Tre, Italy (23–24 Jan). Piepoli, L., Goffredo, R., **Ragno, R.** Northern Apulia Coastal Survey. Archeologia dei paesaggi costieri della Puglia settentrionale: problemi, metodi e risultati preliminari.
- 2023** Speaker. BHDC 2023 – Big Historical Data Conference, Max Planck Institute of Geoanthropology, Jena, Germany (22–25 Nov). **Ragno, R.** Understanding variation in zooarchaeological NISP data: Bayesian betabinomial models for Italian contexts in the 1st millennium CE.
- 2022** Speaker. LAC 2022 – International Landscape Archaeology Conference, University of Iași, Romania (13 Sep). **Ragno, R.** Seeds of Change: An Integrated Approach to Regionality and Peasant Autonomy in 1st millennium CE Italy.
- 2021** Speaker. AIAZ – 10th National Zooarchaeology Conference, University of Siena, Italy (3–6 Nov). **Ragno, R.** The transition from Late Antiquity to the Early Middle Ages in Northern Italy: an Environmental Archaeology Approach.

Research Visits

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, UK

VISITING RESEARCHER

Jan. - Apr. 2023

- Research stay at the McDonald Institute for Archaeological Research, focused on learning Bayesian statistical methods for archaeological research.
- Supervisors: Professor Enrico Crema (MIAR), Dr. Chris Stevens (MIAR), Professor Caroline Goodson (History)
- Collaboration with the ERC-funded Encounter project, for which I developed R workflows to clean, standardise, and collate archaeobotanical datasets.

Field Experience

Northern Apulia Coastal Survey

Apulia, Italy

UNIVERSITY OF BARI, UNIVERSITY OF FOGGIA, MCGILL UNIVERSITY

2024–Current

- Co-coordinating the design and implementation of an archaeological field survey.
- Managed field data collection, database organisation, and designed tailored statistical analyses to investigate settlement dynamics and landscape change.

ArchaeoSipontum

Manfredonia, Italy

UNIVERSITY OF BARI, UNIVERSITY OF FOGGIA

2021, 2022, 2024, 2025

- Participated in archaeological excavations, contributing to stratigraphic documentation, pottery classification, and post-excavation activities.
- Supervised and trained students in excavation methods, recording procedures, and archaeological interpretation.
- Supported the organisation and management of fieldwork activities.

Biomolecular Archaeology Lab

UCL, London

VOLUNTEER

Oct 2019 - Nov. 2019

- Assisted with the preparation of faunal bone samples for ZooMS analysis, performing labelling, photography, weighing, and drilling procedures.

Salapia Exploration Project

Trinitapoli, Italy

UNIVERSITY OF FOGGIA, MCGILL UNIVERSITY

Jun. - Jul. 2015, 2017, 2018

- Excavation tasks, stratigraphic documentation and Roman/Medieval pottery classification.

Programma Vesuviana

Bologna/Pompeii, Italy

UNIVERSITY OF BOLOGNA

2017

- Research and documentation cooperating in particular to the activities of building analysis (identification, cataloguing, digitisation of the stratigraphy of buildings occupying *insulae* IX 5, IX 8 and IX 9 of the archaeological site of Pompeii).
- Developed a web app, connected to the project's database, that allows students to fill the excavation forms on-site through their mobile devices or computers.
- Assisted the scientific organisation of academic conferences.

Teaching

From Data to Interpretation (A11/B5)

University of Cambridge, UK

GUEST LECTURER

Feb. 2027 (confirmed)

- Designed four lectures on archaeological sampling, diversity measures, and reproducible research for the undergraduate paper convened by Prof. Enrico Crema.

From Data to Interpretation (A11); Quantitative Modelling (B11)

University of Cambridge, UK

UNDERGRADUATE SUPERVISOR

Oct. 2026–Current

- A11: two groups of first- to third-year Archaeology students.
- B11: three groups on statistical modelling in R, with students from Archaeology, Biological Anthropology, Psychology, and Natural Sciences.

Seminari di topografia antica e archeologia dei paesaggi

University of Naples Federico II, Italy

GUEST LECTURER

28 April 2026

- Presentation for PhD students: *Metodi quantitativi applicati alla ricerca dei paesaggi storici della Puglia settentrionale costiera*.

Statistics in Archaeology: From Field Surveys to Landscape Interpretation

University of Foggia

GUEST LECTURER

Apr. 2026

- Lecture for the Master's course in Landscape Archaeology taught by Professor Roberto Goffredo.

Sampling in Archaeological Field Surveys

University of Foggia

GUEST LECTURER

Mar. 2025

- Lecture on archaeological sampling strategies for the Master's course in Landscape Archaeology taught by Professor Roberto Goffredo.

Introduction to Statistics in Archaeology

University of Matera

GUEST LECTURER

Feb. 2024

- Lecture on the role of statistics in archaeology for the course in Archaeological Methods taught by Professor Roberto Goffredo at the *Scuola di specializzazione in beni archeologici*.

Python vs. R: An Archaeological Challenge

University of Bari

CO-ORGANISER AND INSTRUCTOR

Mar. 2022

- Course open to MA and PhD students, providing an introduction to statistical programming languages and their use in archaeology.

Service

PEER REVIEW

- 2024–** Ad hoc Reviewer. Journal of Cultural Heritage (2024–Current); Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports (2025–Current); Journal of Open Archaeology (2026–Current); Quaternary Environments and Humans (2026–Current); Journal of Archaeological Science (2026–Current); Archaeology and Science (2026–Current).

CONFERENCE & SESSION ORGANISATION

- 2026** Co-organiser. EAA 2026 – 32nd European Association of Archaeologists Annual Meeting, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece (26–29 Aug). Session: *Entangled Ecologies: New Integrative Approaches to Understanding Past Human–Environment Systems*.
- 2026** Co-organiser. EAA 2026 – 32nd European Association of Archaeologists Annual Meeting, National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Greece (26–29 Aug). Roundtable: *Untangling Resilience and Continuity Across the Archaeological Record*.
- 2025** Co-organiser. EAA 2025 – 31st European Association of Archaeologists Annual Meeting, University of Belgrade, Serbia (2–6 Sep). Session: *Beyond Conquest: Environmental and Cultural Impacts of Roman Expansionism*.

OPEN RESEARCH

- 2026–** Data Champion, University of Cambridge. Participate in regular meetings of the University's Data Champions network, engaging with open research and data management practices.

Skills

DIGITAL TOOLS QGIS, Office suite, Adobe suite

FRONT-END HTML, CSS, R Markdown

PROGRAMMING R, Stan, Python (Basic), LaTeX, SQL, Git/GitHub

LANGUAGES Italian (Native), English (Fluent), French (Basic), Latin (Intermediate)

Licenses

DRIVING	A (EU), B (EU)
DRONES	A1, A3 (EU, UK)
ARCHAEOLOGY	First-Tier Professional Qualification (Italy, Art. 9-bis)